

TOURISM IMPORTANT TOPICS

Exam Preparation Guide & Blueprint Summary

This guide outlines the recurring themes and high-weightage topics for Exam preparation, categorized into Subject-Specific and Employability skills.

1. Subject Specific Skills (Core Tourism)

Tour Packaging and Costing

- **Packaging:** Elements and the step-by-step designing process.
- **Components:** Understanding Direct, Indirect, Explicit, Implicit, Fixed, and Variable costs.
- **Pricing:** Rack Rate Pricing vs. Last-Minute Pricing.
- **Cost Sheets:** Definition and structure.

Government and Professional Bodies

Focus on roles, full forms, and objectives of:

- TAAI, IATO, PATA, ASTA, ADTOI, and UFTAA.

Itinerary Planning

- Meaning and vital importance in travel.
- **Types:** Skeletal, Technical, Descriptive, Tourist, and Vendor.
- Key prerequisites for preparation.

GDS (Global Distribution System)

- Features and major systems: SABRE, Galileo, Amadeus.
- USDOT Regulations.

Travel Agency Operations

- Retail Travel Agency workflows and Vertical Integration.

- **Tour Categories:** Escorted, Hosted, FIT (Free Independent Traveler), and Incentive tours.
- Historical context: The role of **Thomas Cook**.

Transport Network

- Impact of transport efficiency on tourism.
- **Air:** A320, B-747, and B-737 specifications.
- **Water:** Shipping vs. Cruises ("floating resorts").

2. Employability Skills (10 Marks)

Entrepreneurial & ICT Skills

- **Entrepreneurship:** Competencies, qualities, and industry barriers.
- **ICT:** Spreadsheet basics (Sorting, Filtering, Formulas in Calc) and password protection.

Green & Management Skills

- **Green Skills:** Ecotourism benefits and green-collar worker roles.
- **Communication:** Active Listening (RESPECT acronym).
- **Psychology:** Paranoid vs. Schizoid personality disorders.
- **Self-Motivation:** The concept of "Dreaming Big."

Note: Ensure a strong focus on the costing components and GDS features as they are high-scoring areas in previous blueprints.